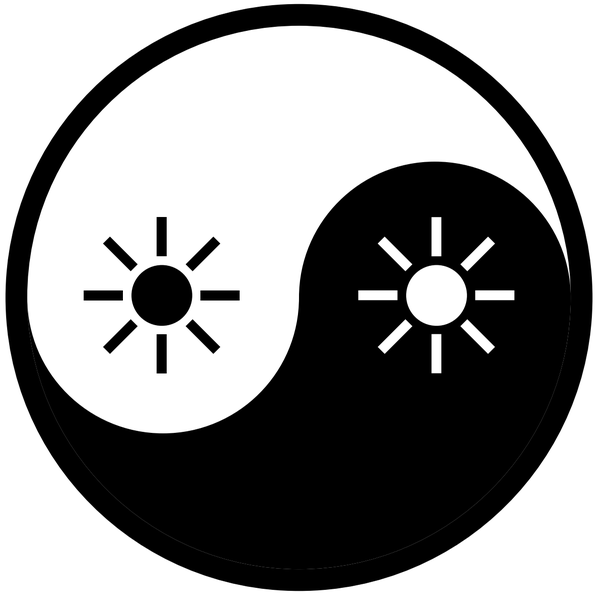


SVARTLJUS is a collective designing dynamic lighting installations that fuse nature with technology. Grounded in the radical ethos of rave and participatory culture, our site-specific works embrace play, modularity, and spontaneous interaction—fluidly adapting to their environment.

SVARTLJUS

Svartljus is a collective of artists and technologists working with intermedia light sculptures. Formed in 2017 at Stugan, a co-created makerspace in Sickla, Stockholm, the group emerged from a bohemian and makeshift creative environment. Stugan was housed in a demolition lease building next to Nobelberget, a hub for underground culture. It was also adjacent to The Node, a focal point for Stockholm's Burning Man community, which was closely tied to The Borderland—then held in Gotland, later moving to Denmark, and now based in Alversjö, Sweden.

When Svartljus co-founder Jonas Johansson returned to Stockholm after years abroad, he brought a growing interest in custom-built lighting fixtures, and interactive systems. At Stugan, he connected with Olle Bjerkås and Markus Persson, and together they began experimenting with light as an artistic and spatial medium.

In 2017 they kicked off their collective with a bespoke installation for Spotify, a light tunnel that served as both entrance and exit, featuring two arrays of LED columns, all controlled in real time. Following the success of this initial collaboration, they continued working together on various projects.

In 2018, Per-Olov Jernberg joined the team, bringing expertise in hardware and software development, enabling Svartljus to create more complex, reactive systems. That year, they exhibited at Sónar Reykjavík, where they not only presented an installation but also ran a workshop on building lighting installations, sharing their technical and artistic approaches.

Svartljus soon became known for its club-based lighting installations, working at Slakthusetv, a then key venue in Stockholm's electronic music scene. Their work accompanied performances by artists such as John Digweed and Township Rebellion. Beyond clubs, Svartljus became involved in hackathons, designing lighting for events such as the Stagecast hackathons at Reaktorhallen, a former nuclear reactor hall repurposed as an experimental event space.

In 2019, Svartljus had their first intern with Ida Maria Aunsbjerg Villadsen (KADK), which later developed into a collective residency program with multiple students at a time. Hosted by Blivande, Frihamnen.

In 2020, Svartljus brought their work to Into the Woods, creating an installation under the guise of the Wood Wide Web, exploring interconnectivity through organic light structures. By this time, Stugan had been demolished, and the group had relocated to Blivande, a new co-creative space in Stockholm, where they developed and refined what became Dendrolux. An installation which since its birth taken on many forms, and continues to evolve.
The now established Svartljus internship program was continued with students Susanna Engström (Högskolan Dalarna), and Victoria Albrecht (Hyper Island).

While developing Dendrolux, Svartljus integrated a mobile solar power system to explore off-grid solutions for natural settings—an approach Jonas had tested at the Nowhere festival, a solar punk desert event. Around this time, the collective also began creating custom hardware for efficient power and logic distribution, along with modular mounts (drawing on Olle Bjerkås's experience) and unique diffusion techniques that later defined their lighting design.

In 2021, a second iteration of the internship programme took place place with Tiziano Leonardi (Hyper Island), Jenny Forsberg (Högskolan Dalarna), Emil Ahlgren (Beckmans) and Elias Aabjerg (Hyper Island), who later joined the collective. That same year, Svartljus expanded into architectural lighting, designing long-range lighting sculptures for Markuskyrkan, integrating dynamic illumination into architectural spaces.

For Copenhagen Light Festival 2022, Svartljus introduced sound-responsive technology, collaborating with musician signal processing expert Servando Barreiro from Rumtiden Idea Lab, integrating real-time audio-reactive lighting systems.

In 2024, architect Rose Hallgren and metal artist Lior Nonne Malue Hansen joined, bringing the collective to seven core members with expertise in:

- Metal art & fabrication
- Architecture & spatial design
- Coding & interactive systems
- Sound design & signal processing
- Project management & production
- Participatory & community-based design

From underground raves and festival installations to hackathons, architectural interventions, and high-profile commissions, Svartljus continues to explore light on their own terms, combining modular designs with experimental interfaces. Their work explores the intersection of technology, nature, and human experience, evolving as they develop new ways to shape and manipulate light in space.

CV (selection)

Upcoming
PLX Tjärö (2025)
Borderland, Alversjö (2025)

Past
Tjolöholm Slott (2024)
Into the Woods Festival, Unnaryd (2024)
Copenhagen Light Festival (2023)
Copenhagen Light Festival (2022)
Markuskyrkan, Stockholm (2021)
ABBA Voyage Album Release, Gröna Lund (2021)
PLX Tjärö (2021)
Into the Woods Festival, Unnaryd (2020)
Sónar Reykjavík (2018)
Slakthuset, Stockholm (2018-2020)
Stagecast Hackathons at Reaktorhallen (2018-2021)
Spotify (2017)

Interns
Jenny Forsberg (2021)
Tiziano Leonardi (2021)
Emil Åhlgren (2021)
Elias Aabjerg (2021)
Susanna Engström (2020)
Victoria Albrecht (2020)
Ida Maria Aunsbjerg Villadse (2019)

SVARTLJUS

JONAS JOHANSSON

Jonas is an artist, educator, and designer working with motion graphics, immersive media, and audiovisual art. Originally from Halland, he works between Stockholm, Falkenberg and Malmö.

Jonas has worked with KRAM/WEISSHAAR (SE/DE), FIELD (UK), and Moment Factory (CA), working on technology-driven design, interactive installations, and stage experiences. In addition to his artistic and curatorial work, he is a senior lecturer in Visual Communication at Beckmans College of Design.

He holds a Bachelor's in Graphic Design from Linköping University, an Interactive Art Director diploma from Hyper Island, and has studied Design Graphique et Multimédia in Reims and Art, Play & Games at Valand Academy.

OLLE BJERKÅS

Olle is an artist, maker, organiser, and facilitator working with participatory culture, geometric design, and playful construction. Since 2008, he has developed a wide range of projects—from co-creating festivals to inventing modular building kits and sculptural systems.

He is currently focused on light sculptures and geometric collaboratory design interventions for festivals, science centres, theatres, homes, and public spaces—combining hands-on making with visual exploration and relationship building.

Olle is part of Lekplatsbolaget, a Stockholm-based network of designers and artists building imaginative playgrounds across Sweden, creating public spaces that invite play, gathering, and wonder.

PER-OLOV JERNBERG

Per-Olov "Possan" is technologist and programmer building bespoke hardware and software. He's a long-time collaborator of Håkan Lidbo and the Rumtiden Idea Lab, where he has built countless interactive installations and experiences for museums and exhibitions, in Sweden as well as internationally. His work spans web frontend development, DSP/audio programming, realtime 3D graphics, mobile applications, and physical computing.

With a background in both creative and technical systems, Per-Olov bridges engineering with playful prototyping and future-facing ideas.

SERVANDO BARREIRO

Servando is a musician, technologist, and creative coder working between sound, code, and experimental visual art. With a background in electronics, Pure Data programming, and open-source technologies, his practice spans interactive installations, modular synthesis, and live audiovisual performance.

Originally from Spain and currently based in Berlin, Servando explores the expressive potential of custom-built tools and systems—transforming hardware and software into dynamic instruments. Recent projects include the Audiocomputer, a standalone audio device for performance and composition, and a residency at EMS Stockholm, where he deepened his exploration of modular synthesis and sound design.

ROSE HALLGREN

Rose is a multidisciplinary architect, artist, and designer based in Stockholm, working wherever a project, vision, or whisper may lead. Her practice moves across materials and disciplines, with a curiosity and commitment to continuous learning.

She is currently exploring weaving and ceramics, integrating new skills into future projects. Alongside her design work, she documents architectural spaces, light installations, and visual art through photography.

ELIAS AABJERG

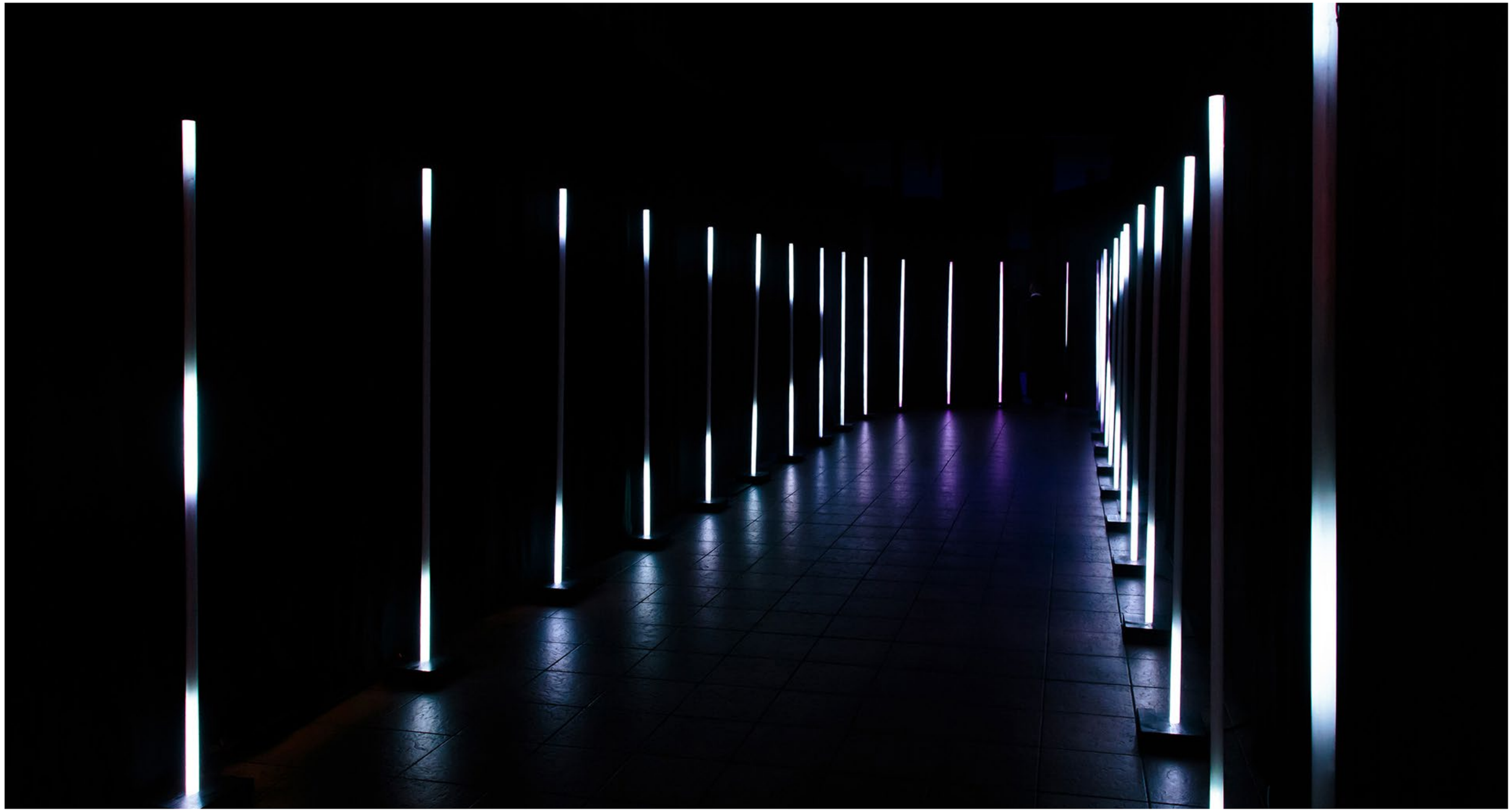
Elias is an artist, designer, and silversmith, with a background in jewellery design, audiovisual installations, and event production, he works across material craft, lighting, and immersive environments.

He is the founder of GRUS, an independent jewellery label exploring form, texture, and symbolism through handcrafted pieces. As a freelance technician and experience designer, he contributes to installations, scenography, and large-scale events.

LIOR NØNNE MALUE HANSEN

Lior is an artist working with large-scale sculptures and installations that explore ecology, politics, psychology, and the contradictions of being human. Her practice engages with discarded materials, uncovering their latent potential as a way to question systems of value and function.

Merging poetic absurdity with tactile precision, Lior's works often resemble a surreal collision between amusement park and junkyard—evoking both vulnerability and resilience. Educated at the Royal Institute of Art in Stockholm, she collects, builds, and reflects—constructing layered worlds that ask not only what it means to feel, but how we make sense of it all.



Light Tunnel. Spotify (2017), Stockholm

Semiosphere, Urban Burn (2018), Stockholm.

Dendrolux, Into the Woods (2020), Unnaryd. Photo Rose Hallgren.

Dendrolux, Into the Woods (2020), Unnaryd. Photo Rose Hallgren.

Dendrolux, Into the Woods (2020), Unnaryd. Photo Rose Hallgren.

Dendrolux, Copenhagen Light Festival (2021).

Dendrolux, Copenhagen Light Festival (2022).

Dendrolux, PLX Tjärö (2022).

Autolux, Into the Woods (2024). Photo Per-Olov Jernberg.

Dendrolux, Tjolöholm Slott (2024). Photo Rose Hallgren.

Dendrolux, Tjolöholm Slott (2024). Photo Rose Hallgren.

Dendrolux, Norra Bantorget (2024). Photo Rose Hallgren.